Series Editor's Preface

When one examines the vast variety of philosophical views that originated in India, the term 'Indian Philosophy' might seem more accurately replaced by 'Indian philosophies'. This is true of all national terms applied to philosophy, of course, but rarely so true as in the case of Indian philosophy. This got off the ground perhaps as long ago as 1000 BCE with the *Rig Veda*, and developed into highly sophisticated schools of thought linked to a series of religious texts. Then Indian philosophy was boosted by a reaction to *Vedantic* thought by Buddhists and others, and this form of philosophy migrated to the rest of Asia, and beyond. Teachers of the history of philosophy often complain that their students today find it difficult to understand Locke and Hume, even if they are native English speakers. How much more difficult, then, is it for an English-speaking audience to understand the concepts of Indian philosophy, distant as they are from us in time and expressed in an entirely distinct language and culture? Chris Bartley's book is designed to show that the task of explaining Indian philosophical concepts is not as difficult or mysterious as has often been thought. It is the aim of this series to present philosophical terms from different areas of the discipline in accessible and interesting ways, and I welcome this contribution to the task in hand.

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